Read the idioms and discuss the questions with a partner.

have a heart of gold

be as good as gold

have a heart of gold

1. What do you think the idioms mean?
2. Do you have any similar idioms in your language?

Read the first paragraph of the article on the right and compare it with your ideas.

From ancient times, gold has been of great importance to mankind. *Many languages reflect this, using gold as a way of describing anything which is beautiful or valuable.*
In English, kind people 'have a heart of gold', particularly well-behaved children are 'as good as gold' and a 'golden opportunity' is one not to be missed.

Watch the video and unlock the code about improving your reading speed.

5 Ways to Read Faster That ACTUALLY Work - College Info ...
YouTube

1. What methods were mentioned it the video?
2. What way do you prefer?
3. What does «skimming» mean?

Now read the whole article and underline the topic sentence in each paragraph.

Sveta

Remember, topic sentences are usually at the beginning of a paragraph.

1. From ancient times, gold has been of great importance to mankind. Many languages reflect this, using gold as a way of describing anything which is beautiful or valuable. In English, kind people 'have a heart of gold', particularly well-behaved children are 'as good as gold' and a golden opportunity' is one not to be missed.

2. The Ancient Greeks believed that gold was a combination of water and sunshine due to its brightness, and the Inca Kingdom called it the 'tears of the sun'. Gold may not have come from the sun, but it probably did come from another planet. The fact that it is always found on or near the surface of the Earth is possible evidence that it may have been brought here by asteroids.

3. Although it is found on every continent, gold is extremely rare. It is estimated that if all the gold in the world was put together, it would make a block of only twenty square metres. Its rarity adds to its value.

4. Gold is particularly treasured in the Middle East, China and India, where more than three billion people prefer to keep their wealth in gold, rather than as money in the bank. As well as being an investment, gold jewellery also has an important cultural role. Half the gold that Indians buy each year is bought for a wedding or other celebration.

5. Gold also has a multitude of less traditional uses in industry. It is not affected by air or water, making it an excellent protective coating for machinery. It is also well suited for conducting heat or electricity.

Nika

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Use the topic sentences you have identified to help you match paragraph headings a-f to paragraphs 1-5 from the article. There is one heading you do not need.

a) Not from this world?

b) How gold is used in modern manufacturing

c) Gold as a symbol or metaphor

d) The importance of gold in certain countries

e) Some medical uses for gold

f) There is less gold than you might think

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Make a list of 4-5 items in your house that you would choose to try and save in an emergency (not including people or pets).

Read the information in the Vocabulary focus box about noun suffixes.

VOCABULARY FOCUS noun suffixes

- ***Certain suffixes tell you that the word is a noun. Recognizing these suffixes can help you understand a word, as well as increase your vocabulary.***
- ***Some of the most common noun suffixes are:***

-ence (reference)	*-ance (appearance)*
-ery (bravery)	*-ity (reality)*
-tion (intention)	*-dom (wisdom)*
-ment (measurement)	

- ***Sometimes adding a suffix causes small changes in spelling, for example:***

enter → entrance	*converse → conversation*
curious → curiosity	*vary → variation*
scarce → scarcity	*jewel → jewellery*

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Work with a partner. Find at least one noun in the article with each of the following suffixes.

1. - ance _____
2. - ity _____
3. - ment _____
8. - tion _____
5. -ence _____
6. -ery _____
7. -dom _____

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2. - ity _____
3. - ment _____
8. - tion _____
5. -ence _____
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7. -dom _____

Complete the sentences using the correct form of the words in brackets.

1. Winning a gold medal is quite an _____ (achieve)
2. All her gold jewellery was taken in the _____ (rob).
3. The gold necklace was part of her _____ (inherit).
4. The Incas were an ancient _____ (civilize).
5. Thank you for your _____ (generous).
6. The whole village received an _____(invite) to the wedding.
7. Having enough money gives you the _____ (free) to do what you want.
8. Gold has a special _____ (signify) in some countries.
9. I have a _____ (prefer) for silver jewellery, rather than gold.
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